MUSIC

SPACE ODYSSEY

Komorebi's latest project, 'The Fall', comprises an album, comic book and music videos, and tells the story of a runaway alien



Tarana Marwah has always understood that one of pop music's biggest strengths is its embrace of joyful escapism. For her 2017 debut album *Soliloquy*, the avant-pop artist—who makes music as 'Komorebi'—she conjured up an entire fantasy world called 'Candyland', a riot of bright anime colours and magical surrealism, within which she situated introspective little songs that explored inner turmoil and troubled relationships. She leans even further into quixotic world-building with her sprawling new conceptual project 'The Fall'—spread across an album, a 30-page comic book and technically ambitious music videos—which tells the story of a runaway alien who crash lands on Planet Earth.

"I really like performative art, and I like building characters and creating worlds," says Marwah over the phone from New Delhi, where she's busy rehearsing for an upcoming tour. "It partly stems from this escapist fantasy world I would go to when I was a child. I loved television anime, I loved video games. I love immersing myself in that kind of environment, and it's a really good escape from reality."

Marwah has been playing around with Kiane, the album's space-travelling protagonist, for years, ever since she started making music as Komorebi. "She's a space traveller who's leaving her home planet because she's feeling

FESTIVAL

Sparking Hope

This year's October Jam—an independent arts and music festival in Bengaluru—promises a fiery lineup around the theme of 'lightning'



SONGS OF RESISTANCE
The Gauley Bhai band

IN 2008, with large parts of Bengaluru dug up or cordoned off thanks to the Metro project and massive development works, Maraa, a media and arts collective, launched October Jam as an independent arts festival. The idea behind the free, crowd-funded festival was to reclaim the city's public spaces for the arts. Early editions, often held in Cubbon Park, offered an inclusive vision of our public spaces as open to all.

Over the years though, October Jam has evolved into something a little different—it's now a space where artists gather to engage with a different curatorial theme every year, ranging from how we experience time (*Anti-Clocks*, 2012) to the air we breathe (*Hawa*, 2018). The festival returns for its 15th iteration this month with conversations, film screenings, workshops, comedy shows and musical performances based on the theme of 'lightning'.

"It's been a rough year, in terms of the struggle for livelihood and freedom of speech and expression, so we were thinking of the festival